

T05 — Operator Log

Used continuously during **Phase 4**. Written **contemporaneously** — as the action is taken, not reconstructed at the end of the day.

The operator log is the most important log in the engagement. Session and C2 logs record *what* happened; only the operator can record *why*, what they expected, and how they interpreted the result. That is what makes the report defensible six months later.

Field	Value
Engagement reference	
Operator	
Date (UTC)	
Approved time source	
Measured clock offset / checked (UTC)	

Rules

1. **UTC for every timestamp.** Record the measured offset from the approved source; do not silently rewrite a discrepant timestamp.
2. **Log every action, including failures.** A blocked technique is evidence a control worked, and is often the most valuable finding.
3. **No gaps.** An unexplained gap during an incident window is indistinguishable from concealment.
4. **Field 12 (Description) and field 15 (System modification) are mandatory.** They are the two most commonly skipped and the two most consequential — one turns the log into an explanation, the other makes cleanup possible.
5. **Reconcile against C2 and session logs at end of day.** Resolve discrepancies the same day.

Log entries

Entry [N]

#	Field	Value
1	Start (UTC)	
2	End (UTC)	
3	Operator	
4	Source IP	
5	Destination IP	
6	Destination port	

#	Field	Value
7	Destination system	
8	Pivot IP / port	
9	URL	
10	Tool / application	
11	Command	
12	Description — what I was trying to achieve and why	
13	Output (summary; full output ref.)	
14	Result	☐ Success ☐ Failure ☐ Partial ☐ Blocked by control
15	System modification (<i>feeds T12</i>)	
16	Evidence reference	
17	Comments — interpretation, decisions, anomalies	
18	Stable action ID / T12 item ID where applicable	

Compact chronological log

Use one row for each action. Continue on additional copies of this page when needed.

Start	End	Op	Src IP	Dst IP	Port	Dst system	Tool	Command	Description	Result	Modification	Evidence

Start	End	Op	Src IP	Dst IP	Port	Dst system	Tool	Command	Description	Result	Modification	Evidence
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End-of-day reconciliation

#	Check	✓
1	Every C2 task in the framework log has a corresponding operator log entry	☐
2	Every session log segment is accounted for	☐
3	Every evidence file referenced exists in the repository	☐
4	Every system modification is recorded in T12	☐
5	No unexplained time gaps	☐
6	Discrepancies resolved	☐
7	Material evidence IDs exist and hashes reconcile at the first stable collection point	☐
8	Clock offset remained within tolerance, or affected intervals are annotated	☐

Discrepancies found and resolution:

Response / notes

Name	Signature	Date
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Operator

Reviewed by RT Lead